

Web Scraping Guide

Adding UiPath Data Scraping to the Centralized Travel Price Comparison System

Key idea: In UiPath, web scraping is done with the built-in **Data Scraping wizard** - you click on the web page and it captures the table for you. It cannot be typed into the file by hand. This project includes a **local demo website** (LiveDemoSite/index.html) made for this, so you can scrape safely offline (no MakeMyTrip, no internet).

0. One-time setup

- Install **Google Chrome**.
- Install the **UiPath Chrome extension**: Studio → Home → Tools → UiPath Extensions → Chrome → Install.
- The **UiPath.UIAutomation.Activities** package is already in the project (see Dependencies).

1. Open the local demo website

In your project folder, open **LiveDemoSite/index.html** in Chrome (right-click → Open with → Chrome). It has an **Available Flights** table and an **Available Trains** table. Keep this tab open.

2. Scrape the flights table

- 1 In Studio, open **Workflows\SearchFlights.xaml**.
- 2 On the **Design** ribbon, click **Data Scraping**.
- 3 Click the **first cell** of the flights table (e.g. **IndiGo**).
- 4 When asked for the second element, click the **next row's** first cell (e.g. **Air India**).
- 5 A preview of the columns appears → **Next / Finish** → 'Extract Correlated Data?' → **No**.
- 6 Studio adds an **Extract Table Data** activity (inside a browser scope) with a **DataTable** output.

3. Send the scraped data into the project

- Select the **Extract Table Data** activity → Properties → set its **Output DataTable** to the argument **out_FlightsTable** (or add an Assign: `out_FlightsTable = ExtractDataTable`).
- Rename the scraped columns to exactly: **Airline, FlightNumber, DepartureTime, ArrivalTime, Duration, Fare** (so the 'find cheapest' step can read the Fare column).
- Repeat Steps 2-3 in **Workflows\SearchTrains.xaml** for the trains table (id='trainsTable') → output **out_TrainsTable**, columns TrainName, TrainNumber, DepartureTime, ArrivalTime, Duration, Fare.

4. Run it in LIVE mode

- 1 Run **Main.xaml**.
- 2 On the **Run mode** prompt type **Live** (instead of Demo).
- 3 It opens the site, scrapes the tables, finds the cheapest flight/train, and shows the three results.
- 4 If scraping returns nothing, the project **falls back to demo data** automatically, so outputs always appear.

Do NOT scrape MakeMyTrip or any site whose terms forbid automated access or that use CAPTCHA / anti-bot protection. To use a real source later, change `in_LiveSiteUrl` in `Main.xaml` to a site you are authorised to automate and redo the Data Scraping wizard on it. See `MAKEMYTRIP_NOTICE.md`.

Tip: if the Data Scraping button does nothing, the UiPath Chrome extension is not installed or the browser tab is not focused (see Step 0).